

URANUS

Astronomer William Herschel discovered Uranus in 1781. Four times wider than Earth, this gas giant is circled by 13 thin rings. When the Voyager 2 probe passed the planet in 1986, it gazed upon a bland, blue world, toppled on its side. Uranus's odd orientation causes extremes in sunlight reaching the planet, creating 20-year-long seasons. As the atmosphere heated up, giant storms appeared in its clouds in August 2014.

The atmosphere on Uranus is mainly hydrogen and helium

DATA FILE



Earth



TIME TO ROTATE ONCE: 17.2 hours



YEAR: 84 Earth years



NUMBER OF MOONS: At least 27



CLOUD-TOP TEMPERATURE:
-197°C (-322°F)

Unlike the dazzling rings of Saturn, Uranus's 13 rings are narrow, and as black as coal